

# SmartCare Multispeciality Hospital — Billing & Payment Guide

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## 1. Purpose & Scope

### 1.1 Purpose

This guide establishes transparent, ethical, and structured policies governing outpatient billing, diagnostic charges, inpatient fee structures, deposit schedules, accepted payment methods, refund processing, and financial dispute resolution at SmartCare Multispeciality Hospital.

### 1.2 Scope

This policy applies to all financial transactions conducted across Outpatient Clinics, Inpatient Wards, Emergency Services, Intensive Care Units, Diagnostic Suites, Rehabilitation Centers, and the 24/7 Pharmacy.

## 2. Transparent Billing Framework

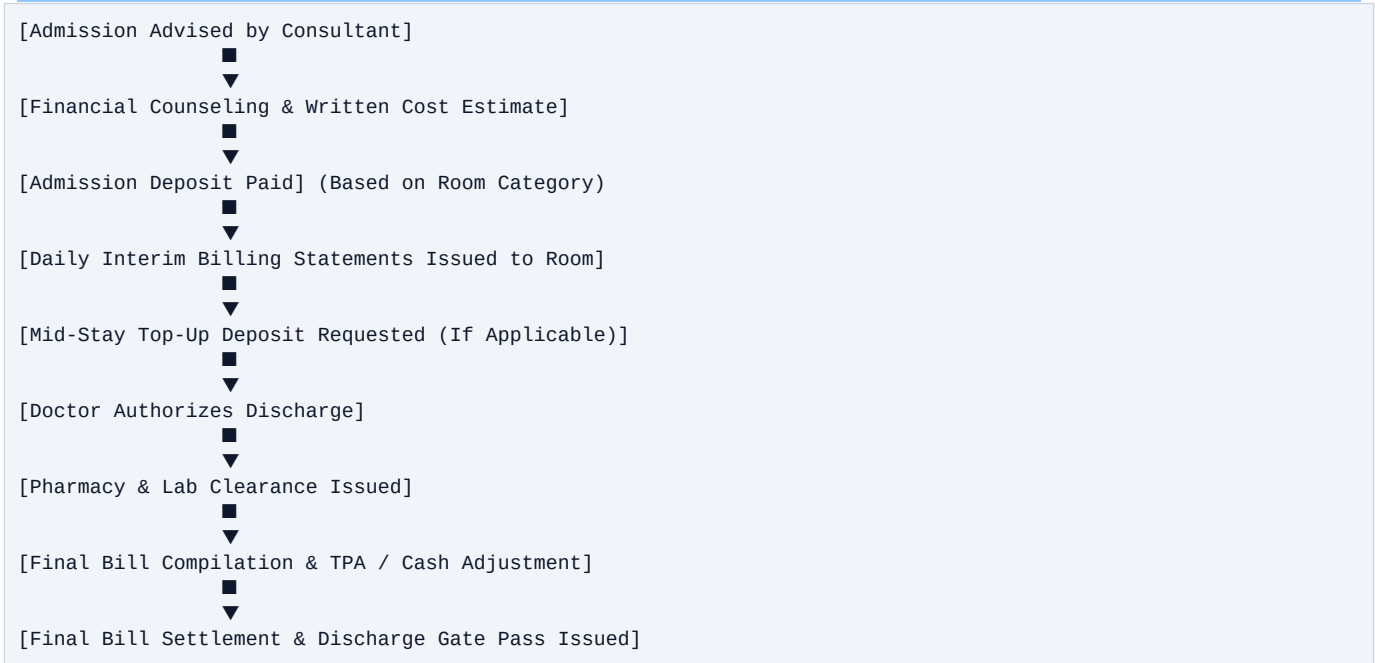
SmartCare Hospital operates on a transparent, published tariff schedule approved by hospital administration. All rates for doctor consultations, diagnostic tests, bed tariffs, and surgical packages are standardized:

- No Hidden Charges:** All service charges, nursing care fees, medical consumable costs, and statutory taxes are itemized on official printed invoices.
- Official Receipting:** Every payment made by a patient or family member must be acknowledged with an official, computer-generated SmartCare receipt containing a unique Receipt Voucher Number and UHID. Hand-written or unofficial receipts are strictly invalid.

## 3. Departmental Billing Areas

| SMARTCARE HOSPITAL BILLING CENTERS |                            |                         |   |
|------------------------------------|----------------------------|-------------------------|---|
| ■ Outpatient (OPD)                 | ■ Inpatient (IP) Billing   | ■ Emergency Billing     | ■ |
| ■ Ground Floor (1-6)               | ■ Level 2 Central Atrium   | ■ Ground Floor ER Desk  | ■ |
| ■ 8:00 AM – 8:00 PM                | ■ 24 Hours / 7 Days a Week | ■ 24 Hours / 7 Days     | ■ |
| ■ Diagnostic Radiology             | ■ Diagnostic Laboratory    | ■ 24/7 Pharmacy Billing | ■ |
| ■ Basement Level 1 Desk            | ■ Ground Floor Lab Wing    | ■ Ground Floor Central  | ■ |
| ■ 8:00 AM – 8:00 PM                | ■ 6:00 AM – 8:00 PM        | ■ 24 Hours / 7 Days     | ■ |

## 4. Comprehensive Inpatient Billing Workflow



## 5. Inpatient Room Categories & Tariff Structure

Room tariffs are calculated on a 24-hour cycle. Partial day stays exceeding 6 hours are billed as a full day.

| Room Category                      | Amenities & Inclusions                                                                                                                            | Nurse-to-Patient Ratio | Deposit Required at Admission |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------------|
| General Multi-Bed Ward             | 6 beds per bay, central air conditioning, shared restroom, curtain privacy partitions, nurse call bell.                                           | 1:5                    | ■15,000                       |
| Semi-Private (Twin Sharing)        | 2 beds per room, shared attached restroom, television, motorized bed, one attendant couch.                                                        | 1:3                    | ■30,000                       |
| Single Private Deluxe Room         | Individual room, attached private restroom, motorized bed, sofa-cum-bed for attendant, refrigerator, television, Wi-Fi.                           | 1:2                    | ■50,000                       |
| Executive Suite                    | Living lounge + patient bedroom, two attached restrooms, dining counter, microwave, premium entertainment system, personalized caregiver service. | 1:1                    | ■1,00,000                     |
| Intensive Care Unit (ICU/CCU/MICU) | Multi-channel cardiac monitor, invasive hemodynamic line, mechanical ventilator provision, isolation capability, advanced life support.           | 1:1                    | ■75,000                       |

*Note: Tariffs reflect standard clinical baseline charges. Surgical operation theater charges, surgeon fees, anesthesia, medications, and diagnostics are billed separately.*

## 6. Accepted Payment Methods

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SmartCare Hospital provides a wide variety of secure payment methods for patient convenience:

1. **Cash Payments:** Accepted at all billing counters up to statutory Indian Income Tax limits (maximum ₹1,99,000 in cash per patient admission).
  2. **Debit & Credit Cards:** Visa, MasterCard, RuPay, Maestro, American Express (Zero merchant surcharge).
  3. **Unified Payments Interface (UPI):** Dynamic QR codes at every counter supporting Google Pay, PhonePe, Paytm, BHIM, and banking UPI apps.
  4. **Internet Banking & NEFT/RTGS:** Direct bank transfers accepted for planned inpatient deposits and major surgical settlements. (Bank account coordinates available at IP billing counter).
  5. **SmartCare Online Patient Portal:** Secure online payments via mobile browser or app.
  6. **Cashless Health Insurance / TPA:** Direct corporate settlements for approved empaneled policyholders.
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## 7. Admission Deposits & Interim Billing Policy

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### 7.1 Initial Admission Deposit

Every patient admitted to SmartCare Hospital (except emergency trauma cases undergoing immediate resuscitation) is required to pay an initial admission deposit based on their selected room category or surgical package.

### 7.2 Daily Interim Statements

For patients admitted for more than 48 hours, an itemized **Daily Interim Bill** is delivered to the patient's room or sent via SMS/email every evening. Attendants are encouraged to review these statements daily to track ongoing charges.

### 7.3 Mid-Stay Top-Up Deposits

When ongoing treatment, pharmacy utilization, or surgical expenses exhaust 80% of the initial deposit, the Billing Department will issue a friendly top-up request. Attendants must replenish the deposit within 24 hours to ensure uninterrupted billing clearance.

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## 8. Refund Policy & Procedure

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SmartCare Hospital maintains a fair, transparent refund mechanism:

- **Eligibility:** Excess deposits remaining after final bill settlement, overpayments, or advance consultation fees for cancelled appointments are fully refundable.
  - **Refund Timelines:**
  - **Cash Deposits:** Refunds up to ₹5,000 are disbursed in cash immediately at the Central Cashier Counter upon discharge.
  - **Card / UPI / Net Banking:** Refunds exceeding ₹5,000 or originally paid via digital modes are refunded directly to the original bank account/card within **3 to 5 business days**.
  - **Documentation Required:** Original deposit payment receipts, Discharge Gate Pass, and patient bank details (cancelled cheque or passbook copy) if paid via electronic transfer.
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## 9. Billing Dispute & Grievance Resolution

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If an attendant or patient identifies an apparent discrepancy, duplicate charge, or unreceived service on their itemized bill:

1. **Report to Billing Supervisor:** Contact the Inpatient Billing Desk or call Extension 3344 before signing the final bill.
2. **Clinical Audit Verification:** The Billing Supervisor and Floor Nursing Supervisor will review the nurse's medication administration record (MAR) and diagnostic log against the billed items.
3. **Adjustment Voucher:** Verified errors will be corrected immediately via an official Credit Note or Billing Adjustment Voucher prior to final bill signing.

4. **Escalation:** Unresolved disputes may be escalated to the Finance Manager or the Patient Grievance Officer on Ground Floor.
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## 10. RAG Knowledge Search & Question Triggers

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- **Trigger Queries:** "How much is the room rent?", "What payment methods are accepted?", "How do I get a refund for excess deposit?", "Can I pay hospital bills through UPI / PhonePe?", "Why was I charged for non-medical items?", "Can I see my daily bill while in hospital?", "How much deposit is needed for ICU admission?", "Can I get an estimated cost for surgery?"
  - **Standardized Fact Base:** Billing counters operate Mon–Sat (8 AM – 8 PM); IP billing is 24/7. Cash accepted up to ₹1,99,000; UPI, Cards, Net Banking, and TPA accepted. Daily interim bills provided. Excess deposits refunded in 3–5 business days.
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## 11. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

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### Q1: What are the operating hours of the billing counters?

A: Central OPD and diagnostic billing counters operate Monday through Saturday from 8:00 AM to 8:00 PM. Inpatient billing and Emergency billing operate 24 hours a day, 7 days a week.

### Q2: Can I pay hospital bills using UPI apps like Google Pay or PhonePe?

A: Yes. All SmartCare billing counters feature dynamic UPI QR codes supporting Google Pay, PhonePe, Paytm, and any UPI-enabled banking app.

### Q3: Can I get an estimated cost of treatment before surgery?

A: Yes. The Financial Counseling Desk provides an official written cost estimate for surgical procedures, hospital stay, and anticipated medications based on your doctor's clinical plan.

### Q4: How much deposit is required at the time of admission?

A: Admission deposits depend on room category: General Ward is ₹15,000, Semi-Private is ₹30,000, Single Deluxe is ₹50,000, Executive Suite is ₹1,00,000, and ICU is ₹75,000.

### Q5: Is credit card payment subject to an extra service fee?

A: No. SmartCare does not charge any merchant surcharge or convenience fee on debit card, credit card, or UPI transactions.

### Q6: Can I see my running bill during a hospital stay?

A: Yes. Daily interim billing statements are generated every evening and sent via SMS/email or delivered physically to your room upon request.

### Q7: How is room rent calculated?

A: Room rent is billed on a 24-hour cycle from the time of admission. If a stay on the day of discharge exceeds 6 hours, a full day's room charge applies.

### Q8: What happens if my admission deposit is higher than my final bill?

A: Any excess deposit remaining after settling your final bill is fully refunded to you. Cash refunds up to ₹5,000 are paid immediately; higher amounts or electronic payments are refunded via bank transfer in 3–5 business days.

### Q9: What documents do I need to collect an electronic refund?

A: You need to submit your original deposit receipts, discharge summary copy, and a cancelled bank cheque or bank account statement showing your Account Number and IFSC code.

### Q10: Can I pay my hospital bill online from home?

A: Yes, you can view and pay outpatient and inpatient bills securely through the SmartCare Patient Portal at <https://www.smartcarehospital-demo.org/pay>.

### Q11: Are doctor consultation fees included in the daily room rent?

A: No. Doctor visit fees, specialist cross-consultations, diagnostic tests, medications, surgical charges, and nursing care procedures are billed separately from room rent.

### Q12: Can I pay in cash for bills exceeding ₹2,00,000?

A: Under Indian Income Tax laws (Section 269ST), cash receipts of ₹2,00,000 or more from a single individual in a day are strictly prohibited. Amounts of ₹2,00,000 and above must be paid via card, bank transfer, or UPI.

### Q13: What should I do if I notice a medication on my bill that was not given to me?

A: Immediately alert the Inpatient Billing Supervisor before settling your final bill. The supervisor will cross-verify with the Nursing Medication Administration Record (MAR) and correct any discrepancy.

**Q14: Can foreign credit cards be used at the hospital?**

A: Yes, international Visa and MasterCard credit cards are accepted at all main billing desks. Transactions are processed in Indian Rupees (INR).

**Q15: Can I get financial assistance or concessions if I cannot afford treatment?**

A: SmartCare has a dedicated Medical Social Work Department that reviews economically disadvantaged cases for potential welfare discounts, charitable trust support, or government healthcare funds.

**Q16: Are pharmacy medicines billed directly to the room during an inpatient stay?**

A: Yes. Inpatient medications prescribed by your treating doctor are dispensed by the 24/7 Pharmacy and automatically debited to your ongoing indoor hospital folio.

**Q17: Can I take home unused medicines dispensed during hospitalization for a refund?**

A: Sealed, unexpired, non-refrigerated medicines returned within 24 hours of discharge with the original billing slip can be credited back to your account. Opened ampoules or cold-chain biologicals cannot be returned.

**Q18: What is a Discharge Gate Pass?**

A: A Discharge Gate Pass is an official document issued by the billing department once the final bill is settled or insurance clearance is finalized, permitting the patient to leave the hospital premises.

**Q19: How do I get an itemized bill for tax purposes or medical reimbursement?**

A: The Inpatient Billing Counter automatically provides a detailed itemized final bill with complete break-ups of doctor fees, room tariffs, investigations, and medications at discharge.

**Q20: What happens if an emergency patient cannot pay the deposit immediately?**

A: In medical emergencies, life-saving stabilization and clinical care are initiated immediately. Attendants are given reasonable time (up to 24 hours) to arrange financial deposits or insurance papers.

**Q21: Does the hospital charge extra for emergency doctor consultations at night?**

A: Emergency department physician evaluations carry a standardized emergency consultation tariff. Specialist emergency call-in visits during nighttime hours may carry an after-hours specialist call-in charge.

**Q22: Can I pay part of my bill with insurance and the rest with my credit card?**

A: Yes. Any co-payment, deductible, or non-medical expense not approved by your insurance company can be settled at the counter using card, cash, or UPI.

**Q23: How can I obtain duplicate copies of paid bills from past visits?**

A: You can download digital copies of all past invoices from the SmartCare Patient Portal or request stamped physical duplicates at the Central Billing Desk by providing your UHID.

**Q24: Can I pay an advance deposit via bank transfer before my scheduled surgery date?**

A: Yes. You can transfer funds directly to SmartCare Hospital's bank account via NEFT/RTGS. Contact the billing desk to obtain the verified account number and provide your transfer UTR number.

**Q25: Who should I contact if I have a question about my bill after reaching home?**

A: You can contact our Central Billing Enquiries line at +91-40-6999-3344 or email [billing@smartcarehospital-demo.org](mailto:billing@smartcarehospital-demo.org), quoting your UHID and Bill Number.

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## 12. Official Contact Directory

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- **Central Inpatient & Outpatient Billing Desk:** Ground Floor & Level 2 Atrium
- **Direct Phone:** +91-40-6999-3344 / +91-40-6999-3345
- **Email:** [billing@smartcarehospital-demo.org](mailto:billing@smartcarehospital-demo.org) / [accounts@smartcarehospital-demo.org](mailto:accounts@smartcarehospital-demo.org)
- **Hours:** OPD Counters: Mon–Sat, 8:00 AM – 8:00 PM; Inpatient Billing: 24/7